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Follett Software

Senior Director, Software Development

****Target Role:**** Senior Director, Software Development ****Lead Record:**** [`wwwworkremote` Lead #126] (<http://localhost:31000/admin/leads/126>) / [Posting #5624](http://localhost:31000/api/v0/job_postings/5624)

****Company Profile:**** Follett Software (Chicago, IL / Remote — K–12 Education Technology, Destiny Library Platform) ****Tone Calibration:**** Understated, zero-fluff, honest level assessment. --- ## 1. Role Scope & Stack Analysis * ****Scope:**** Executive engineering director leading multiple product lines (Destiny Library Manager, Resource Manager, Accessit Library). Manages Development Managers and Senior Engineers. * ****Core Technical Mandate:**** Legacy modernization (Java, J2EE, .NET, JBoss, WildFly, SQL Server, jQuery → Azure cloud microservices), back-to-school peak load reliability, Spec-Driven Development, and AI workflow adoption. * ****Management Burden:**** Direct people management, performance coaching, succession planning, recruiting, and budget ownership across multiple product managers/teams. --- ## 2. Fit & Level Calibration (Skeptical Peer Lens) | Dimension | Target Role Expectation | Mike's Grounded Signal | Fit Status | | :--- | :--- | :--- | :--- | | ****Technical Mandate**** | Modernize legacy Java/J2EE/.NET monoliths to cloud; establish Spec-Driven workflows & telemetry. | Led OneMain Acquisition lane modernization, OpenTelemetry enterprise rollout across 36+ services, and 90-day EMR-Bear legacy audit. |  Strong Match | | ****Operational Peak**** | Ensure 100% uptime during high-stakes back-to-school enrollment peak. | Handled peak loan acquisition load; reduced system-wide MTTR by 60% via real-time tracing. |  Strong Match | | ****Role Track**** | Executive People Director (managing managers, HR reviews, budget tracking). | Principal Software Engineer / Staff Architect (Technical IC leadership; OneMain Associate Director was an IC corporate grade with no direct reports). |  Track Mismatch | | ****Work Environment**** | Heavy synchronous management & cross-departmental administrative meetings. | High-autonomy Principal IC track with async RFC/ADR documentation focus. |  Potential Friction | --- ## 3. Strategic Recommendation * ****Primary Recommendation:** De-prioritize for IC Target Roles.** If your job search priority is a Principal IC / System Architect role with deep technical ownership and low management administrative overhead, this Senior Director post is a structural mismatch. * ****Alternative Pitch (If Pursuing as Chief Architect / Principal):**** If Follett is attractive as a Chicago/Remote EdTech target, do not position as a people-manager. Pitch as a ****Principal Software Engineer / Chief Architect**** who will partner with their

Director of Engineering to execute the multi-product legacy modernization (Java/J2EE -> microservices), enforce Spec-Driven Development standards, and safeguard back-to-school reliability.

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